

**JUSTIFICATION FOR OTHER THAN FULL AND
OPEN COMPETITION (OTFAOC)**

Federal Acquisition Regulation (FAR) Part 6 Justification & Approval (J&A), Supporting
Procurements under FAR Part 12, and FAR Part 15

Purchase Request Number: To be determined

Contract Number: HC1028-15-D-0007

Task Order Numbers: Various

Procurement Title: Communications Technical Support Services (CTSS) III Bridge

Estimated Value: [REDACTED]

Statutory and Regulatory Authority: 10 U.S.C. 3204(a)(1) and FAR 6.302-1

Justification for OTFAOC Number: JA23-060 **MOD 04**

Upon the basis of the following justification, I, as, Procuring Activity Competition Advocate, hereby approve the use of other than full and open competition of the proposed contractual action pursuant to the authority of FAR 6.302-1, Only one responsible source and no other supplies or services will satisfy agency requirements.

1. REQUIRING AGENCY AND CONTRACTING ACTIVITY:

Requesting Agency:

9th Air Force, United States (U.S.) Air Force Central Command (AFCENT),
Communications Directorate (A6)
523 Nelson Ave Shaw AFB, SC 29152

Contracting Activity:

Defense Information Systems Agency (DISA)/Defense Information Technology
Contracting Organization (DITCO) PS8312
2300 East Drive, Bldg. 3600
Scott AFB, IL 62225

2. NATURE/DESCRIPTION OF ACTION(S):

The nature of this action is to extend the ordering period of the contract number HC1028-15-D-0007 under CTSS III for seven months, from September 10, 2023 - April 9, 2024. Currently, these requirements are supported through predominantly cost-plus fixed fee (CPFF) task orders (TOs) awarded against an Indefinite Delivery Indefinite Quantity (IDIQ) contract (CTSS III) performed by General Dynamics Information Technology, Inc. (GDIT). Contract number HC1028-21-D-0002, CTSS IV, was awarded to Trace on September 3, 2021. However, on March 3, 2022, the Contracting Officer (KO) terminated CTSS IV award to Trace for convenience and cancelled the CTSS IV solicitation. Additionally, the Government determined

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that the CTSS acquisition will be resolicited by the U.S. Air Force Air Combat Command, Acquisition Management, and Integration Center (AMIC or the “Air Force”). The re-solicitation effort by AMIC is titled CTSS V.

MOD 01 - The nature of the work to be performed under this contract has not changed. The ordering period of the contract is being extended from April 9, 2024 to November 8, 2024. The follow-on effort was awarded on February 16, 2024, but is currently under protest at the Government Accountability Office. The extended ordering period will ensure there is no break in service during the protest period. The ceiling will not be updated at this time, as the existing ceiling will cover the current extension.

MOD 02: This Justification will increase the CTSS III ceiling [REDACTED], from [REDACTED] to [REDACTED]. This J&A increases the ceiling amount to align with the extended ordering period noted on JA23-060 MOD 01, which was issued in April 2024. The nature of the work to be performed under this contract has not changed. The ordering period of the contract has not changed. This ceiling increase will cover extension of all active task orders to cover the current estimated protest period.

MOD 03: This Justification will increase the CTSS III ceiling by [REDACTED], from [REDACTED]. The ordering period will be extended from November 9, 2024, to April 8, 2025. [REDACTED]

The nature of the work to be performed under this contract and all extensions has not changed. This modification will allow AFCENT to continue mission critical work under the task orders and the IDIQ

MOD 04: This Justification will increase the CTSS III ceiling by [REDACTED], from [REDACTED]. The ordering period will be extended from April 8, 2025, to September 8, 2025.

The nature of the work to be performed under this contract and all extensions has not changed. This modification will allow AFCENT to continue mission critical work under the task orders and the IDIO

3. DESCRIPTION OF SUPPLIES/SERVICES:

The nature of this action is to extend the ordering period of contract number HC1028-15-D-0007 under CTSS III for seven months, from September 10, 2023 until April 9, 2024. This extension will be broken into two periods: the initial bridge of four months from September 10, 2023 - January 9, 2024, and an optional three months from January 10, 2024 - April 9, 2024. This

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extended ordering period will give AMIC time to complete the source selection [REDACTED] and allow for the 90-day transition that is required under the CTSS V solicitation. Additionally, extension until April 9, 2024 will provide coverage for any unexpected delays (e.g., protest) in the execution of services under CTSS V. This Justification's estimated amount is [REDACTED], increasing the ceiling from [REDACTED]. The ceiling amount of [REDACTED] accounts for all task order values through the current CTSS III IDIQ ordering period and future value of all task order extensions necessary during the proposed bridge extension. This increase ensures adequate ceiling to support all active TOs as they transition to CTSS V (including any necessary increases in support of contingency situations).

The CTSS III contract supports U.S. Air Force personnel, who provide communications at U.S. Air Force bases in Southwest Asia (SWA) supporting over 10,000 joint services military personnel and coalition forces. Specifically, these locations include but are not limited to SWA locations such as Bahrain, Jordan, Kuwait, Oman, Qatar, United Arab Emirates, Pakistan, Iraq, and Saudi Arabia. CTSS III provides mission critical communication capabilities, which include telephone switch operations and maintenance (O&M), commercial satellite communications (SATCOM) O&M, technical control facility O&M, network administration/installation O&M, high frequency/ultra-high frequency/very high frequency ground radio O&M, commercial, tactical, and defense red switch O&M, inside/outside cable plant support, cable TV support services, communications security management, communications planning and engineering, video teleconference technical services, military SATCOM O&M, and all other functions normally performed by an Air Force communications squadron. [REDACTED]

MOD 04: The services offered under this contract have not changed. The ordering period will be extended to September 8, 2025, and the ceiling will be increased by [REDACTED], from [REDACTED].

4. IDENTIFICATION OF STATUTORY AUTHORITY:

- (a) Only one responsible source and no other supplies or services will satisfy agency requirements, 10 U.S.C. 3204(a)(1) (FAR 6.302-1/DFARS 206.302-1)

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5. DEMONSTRATION OF CONTRACTOR'S UNIQUE QUALIFICATIONS:

(a) Description of events. In 2022, it was determined that the transfer of the acquisition to the Air Force was in the Government's best interest. For continuity of services, it is in the best interest of the Government to bridge the existing contract until the Air Force is able to award the contract, and complete the transition of services to CTSS V.

(b) Justification.

(1) Minimum Government requirements. AFCENT requires the daily support provided under the CTSS III contract. The services provided under this contract include mission critical communications capabilities supporting joint services military personnel and coalition forces, primarily in the United States Central Command (USCENTCOM) area of responsibility (AOR). It is critical to ensure operations remain uninterrupted while the follow-on CTSS V effort is being competed and the transition period is complete.

(2) Proposed sole source contractor. GDIT is the proposed sole source contractor. As the incumbent contractor under CTSS III, GDIT is already in place in SWA with a [REDACTED] and is the only source that can immediately and completely fulfill this requirement without mission critical failure and risk of a substantial break in service and support to AFCENT. GDIT is currently meeting the Government's CTSS III requirements and has been providing these services since 2015.

GDIT currently maintains housing and vehicle leases, as well as medical clearances for their workforce. The current workforce also has the necessary security clearances, training certifications, and experience for the required labor categories supporting this mission. Therefore, GDIT is the only capable source to provide services to the Government while the Air Force solicits CTSS V.

MOD 04: [REDACTED]

(3) Discussion regarding cause of the sole source situation. [REDACTED]

[REDACTED] No other contractor could effectively transition in to complete the work in a reasonable timeframe. The present CTSS III contract requires services for five TOs in various SWA locations. The CTSS V solicitation requires 90 days to properly transition to a new contractor on to CTSS. The most viable alternative is a bridge action to extend the CTSS III contract to allow for a seamless transition consistent with the CTSS V requirement.

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(4) Impact. [REDACTED]

Mission critical systems supported by CTSS include the Defense Red Switch Network (DRSN). The DSRN provides multilevel secure voice and voice-conferencing capabilities to the National Command Authority, which includes the President and the Secretary of Defense of the United States, the Joint Chiefs of Staff, the National Military Command Center, CENTCOM and their command centers and warfighters. Additionally, CTSS supports the Legacy Defense Switch Network, which provides voice support to over 7,500 deployed warfighters. CTSS also supports all commercial satellite terminal operations and maintenance. [REDACTED]

6. CONTRACT OPPORTUNITIES ANNOUNCEMENT/POTENTIAL SOURCES:

AMIC posted solicitation number FA4890-23-R-CTSS on Sam.gov on December 8, 2022. Five subsequent amendments were posted between December 2022 and May 2023. Proposals were received on May 22, 2023.

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MOD 04: [REDACTED]

7. DETERMINATION OF FAIR AND REASONABLE COST:

The KO will conduct a cost/price evaluation on the CTSS III bridge contract in accordance with FAR Subpart 15.404, as applicable; and in conjunction with customary terms and conditions, historical process and other than cost or pricing data may be utilized. The proposed cost/prices for TOs issued during the extension will be compared to the current contract prices as well as the Independent Government Cost Estimate (IGCE) in order to determine fair and reasonable price.

The IGCE was updated based on historical rates, inflation, and a revision in the indirect rates. As a result of those updates, this J&A for [REDACTED] will increase the ceiling of the CTSS III from [REDACTED]. This increase of [REDACTED] is determined to be sufficient to provide the Government sufficient coverage for ordering of services from September 10, 2023, until April 9, 2024.

MOD 04: The IGCE for the proposed MOD 04 extension and ceiling increase was developed with the same methodology. As a result, the ceiling of CTSS III will increase to [REDACTED] for the extended ordering period through September 8, 2025.

8. MARKET RESEARCH: This is an extension to the existing IDIQ contract's ordering period to ensure continued support until the award and transition of the subsequent follow-on contract is complete. Market research was conducted for the CTSS V solicitation, which enabled the follow-on contract to be solicited competitively.

MOD 04: Market research was conducted for the CTSS V solicitation, which enabled the follow-on contract to be solicited competitively. However, no other contractor can perform the unique nature of the transition services to be provided after award of CTSS V.

9. ANY OTHER SUPPORTING FACTS: It is important to note the unique attributes of the contract. CTSS provides communication services in austere locations throughout the AOR including locations such as Bahrain, Jordan, Kuwait, Oman, Qatar, United Arab Emirates, Pakistan, Iraq, and Saudi Arabia. The contractor must abide by a detailed scheduled transition in close coordination with the Air Force. Contractor personnel must have numerous health and skill-related certifications and pre-deployment training before being eligible to travel to these austere work environments. For example, medical certifications, training certifications, security clearance, and housing and vehicle leases must be completed prior to the personnel travelling to the worksite.

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10. LISTING OF INTERESTED SOURCES: Multiple offerors have expressed interest and submitted proposals in the AMIC source selection. Since the source selection is ongoing, the names of the offerors will not be released by AMIC.

11. ACTIONS THE AGENCY MAY TAKE TO REMOVE OR OVERCOME BARRIERS THAT LED TO THE EXCEPTION TO FULL AND OPEN COMPETITION:

(a) Procurement History: Current Contract: HC1028-15-D-0007

Status: Expires September 9, 2023. Solicitation HC1028-19-R-0009 for the follow-on contract was posted on Sam.Gov on June 29, 2020, as a competitive full and open acquisition. Seven proposals were received, and award was made on September 3, 2021. A stop-work order was issued on September 20, 2021, due to three protests received. The award of CTSS IV was terminated for the Government's convenience in March 2022 and the acquisition will be resolicited as a competitive full and open requirement.

AMIC posted solicitation number FA4890-23-R-CTSS on Sam.gov on December 8, 2022. Five subsequent amendments were posted between December 2022 and May 2023. Proposals were received on May 22, 2023. Proposals are currently being evaluated.

MOD 04: The CTSS III ordering period is set to expire April 8, 2025. [REDACTED]

[REDACTED] The nature of the work to be performed under this contract and all extensions has not changed.

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[REDACTED]

[REDACTED]

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